Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 4 3 ♥ A J 4 ♦ A J ♣ A K 8 3	
♠ K J 9 2 ♥ Q 10 9 3 ♦ 10 9 5 2 ♣ 6	N W E S	♠ Q 8 5 ♥ K 7 2 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 7 5
	♠ 10 7 ♥ 8 6 5 ♦ K Q 7 3 ♣ J 9 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♣5. You play low from dummy and West plays the ♣6.

Winners: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 1 ♦ = 4? ♣ = 3 Total = 9

Although you have 4 ♦ winners, getting to the last couple might not be so easy. You can make 3 ♦ tricks simply by winning your ♦A, then overtaking your ♦J with dummy's ♦Q. But you need that fourth ♦ winner. Can you get it?

Sure you can, by creating an entry in ♣s. It is likely from the opening lead, (and West's play of a small card), that East has led from ♣ Q 10 7 5. If you win the first trick cheaply then you will still make your ♣ A K for three ♣ tricks in all.

So don't win cheaply, win the first trick with the ♣A. Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣K. (on which West discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9. You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

Suppose the opening lead had been a ♦ rather than a ♣.

You probably would have played the hand the same way you just did, unblock ♦s, then play ♣ A K and a low ♣ toward the ♣ J 9 trying to get a ♣ entry to dummy.

It is only because the ♣ opening lead gives you the chance for a Cheap-Trick that you are tempted to go wrong.

Board 3
West Deals
E-W Vul

	North	
	♠ K 7 4 2 ♥ Q 10 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ K 9 2	
West ♠ 8 3 ♥ J 7 4 ♦ A 6 4 2 ♣ 7 6 5 3	N W E S	**East** ♠ A 6 ♥ K 5 2 ♦ K Q J 5 ♣ A Q J 4
	♠ Q J 10 9 5 ♥ A 9 3 ♦ 9 8 3 ♣ 10 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠Q. North plays the ♠K, then the ♠2 when you hold up.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 6

You are going to have to be pretty lucky to make this contract. You cannot touch the ♥ suit because a defender would take the ♥A and it would start raining ♠s.

So you will have to get 3 extra ♣ winners, which means the ♣ finesse absolutely MUST work.

In addition to lucky, you are going to have to be pretty good, too. You will surely have to finesse the ♣s at least twice; that means you need two dummy entries. Can you find them?

Maybe in ♦s. Play the ♦K, then ♦Q, watching the defender's cards carefully. When both follow twice you know there is only a single ♦ left out, so you play the ♦J to dummy's ♦A. Now take the ♣ finesse. It works! Next play your ♦5 to dummy's ♦6 and take another ♣ finesse. Both defenders follow so your ♣s are good.

If the ♦s split 4-1 you would have found out when you cashed the ♦ K Q.

Then your chance of success goes way down. You would have to find North with the doubleton ♣K.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 7 3 ♥ 7 6 4 ♦ 8 5 3 ♣ 9 8	
♠ J 8 6 2 ♥ Q 9 8 ♦ Q J 10 2 ♣ 10 3	N W E S	♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ K J 10 3 ♦ 9 7 4 ♣ 6 2
	♠ - ♥ A 5 2 ♦ A K 6 ♣ A K Q J 7 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT	Pass	6♣
All Pass			

6♣ by South

South is to play 6♣. West leads the ♦Q.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 3

Partner's hand didn't turn out to be what you hoped for, you had in mind maybe the ♥K and ♦Q.

But this is what you got. First, be thankful West led a ♦ rather than a ♥. Second, see if you can find a way to fight yourself over to dummy and those three beautiful ♠s.

You have two possibilities for a ♣ entry, but you can only try one of them as you will see.

You can play a high ♣ and hope somebody plays the singleton ♣10. Then your ♣9 would be an entry. If this works you would probably make all 13 tricks, but the chances are very slim.

You can play a low ♣ to dummy's ♣8. Assuming a defender takes the ♣10 you can win his return and enter dummy with the ♣9. This play is guaranteed to give you the entry and is the one you should choose.

Just in case you were wondering about the chances of that singleton ♣10, here is how you would figure it out.

When you are missing 4 cards the probability of a 3-1 split is about 50%.

But the singleton can be any one of four cards - in this case it can be the ♣10, ♣6, ♣3 or ♣2. So the chance of one of the opponents holding specifically the singleton ♣10 is only one-fourth of 50%, about 12.5%.